

1. I can clearly imagine a scenario in which I wake up in a different body.
2. If I can clearly imagine something being the case, then it is possible for it to be the case.
3. It is possible that I wake up in a different body. (1,2)
4. If it is possible that I wake up in a different body, then materialist theories of survival are false.

C. Materialist theories of survival are false. (3,4)

THE BODY-SWAPPING ARGUMENT

One can also generate swapping arguments against answers to the survival question which focus on immaterial souls.

The argument we just gave is already an argument against views which say that survival requires sameness of body **plus** sameness of immaterial soul.

Next time we'll talk about a swapping argument against the pure "soul survival" theory that requires only sameness of immaterial souls.

THE BODY-SWAPPING ARGUMENT



if it is the case.

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C. Materialist theories of social

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4. If it is possible that I wake up in

if all else fails, 4)





innaterialsoul.

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Next time we'll talk about swapping arguments against the

example.

Today we turn to our third big question. This question can be introduced by an

Suppose that in the year 2069 the surviving members of this Introduction to

this room. Suppose that they decided to get a group picture taken.

Philosophy class decided to have an Intro to Philosophy reunion, and all gathered in

Now imagine that, via some sort of time travel device, I have that photo, and

show it to you. You might ask: Am I one of those people? Which one am I?

But is every natural assumption that these questions must have determined answers?

is you. And, if one is you, there must be some fact about which one is

you.

There must be some fact of the matter about whether or not the people in the photo

Let's suppose that this is true: there must be a fact about whether you survive to be



in this picture, and must be a fact about which the survivors are

Then we can ask a question about these facts:



useful to think about simple, universal example of survival.

To introduce our main answers to the survival question, it will be

the same point another way, all of you believe that the person now

sitting in your seat is the same person as — identical to — the person

who will wake up in your bed tomorrow.

All of you believe that you will wake up tomorrow in your bed. To put

What do we mean when we say that you are identical to that person?

This is the distinction between numerical and qualitative identity.

Here it is important to get clear at the outset on one distinction which, if not

attended to, can make these questions more confusing than they have to be.

Today that x and y are numerically identical is to say that they are literally the

same thing — they are one, not two.

To say that x and y things are qualitatively identical is to say that they

exactly resembling — they have just the same properties.

When we say that you are identical to the person who will get out of your bed

to morning, we are not of course saying that you are qualitatively

identical to that person. Their hair will be messed up, and they will be wearing

different identities.

Rather, we mean that you are numerically identical to that person: there is just

one person who is today in this class, and is tomorrow in that bed.

the same person as the person who will wake up in that bed?

But then we can ask the survival question: in virtue of what are you numerical



But this is not the only answer to our question. It is a

also have innovative materials.

widely held view that we are not simply material beings, but

existence in material soul.

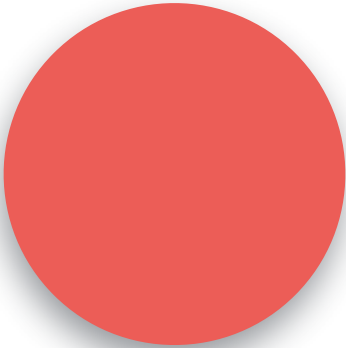
that one's survival is closely linked to the continued

If one believes in immaterial souls, then it is natural to think

This suggests an alternative theory of survival. On this view,

because they are, or have, the same immaterial soul.

the person who wakes up in that bed tomorrow is you



physical connections, and not be afraid of anything involving

immaterial souls, but rather because psychological

But these are not the only possible views here. One might

connections between you and that person.

also hold that you are that person not because of any

you the same person as the person who will wake up in that

focus on memories. On this view, the thing which makes

Which psychological connections? One popular approach

bedtime is your shared memories.

Of course there are plenty of other psychological

connections you will have to that person as well. You will

have very similar beliefs and desires, and very similar

personalities.

Let's call the idea that you are the same person because of

you're psychologically disconnected psychologically survival.